armed forces, ethnic and religious groups, bureaucracy and other factors have been totally ignored. Professor Bandyopadhyaya observes that the dependency on the World System theories are too simplistic and fail to provide satisfactory explanation on the relationship between the domestic structure of a state and the magnitude and direction of its foreign policy. They are preoccupied with the centre–periphery relationship and pay insufficient attention to all these factors. There is also the question of causality involved. Some critics question whether dependency creates economic and social backwardness, as World System theorists claim, or it is economic and social backwardness which create a situation for dependency. There is no agreement on causality, whether dependency is the cause of backwardness or it is the effect of this condition.

Despite such criticisms, World System Theory is not without value. It has made some positive contribution in revealing the real structure of international system which, according to Prof. Bandyopadhyaya, is divided roughly between the dominant North and the dependent South. It also has given a clue to understanding the causes and mechanisms of creation and continuation of this dependency, subordination and marginalization of the poor and developing countries by the oligarchic and hegemonic powers of the international system.